IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS BY THE COUNTY COUNSEL

Measure B would impose a countywide sales tax at the rate of one-half of one percent (1/2%). The tax would apply throughout Napa County, including the cities, town and the unincorporated areas of the county.

The sales tax proceeds can only be used for the purposes outlined in Measure B, which include wildfire preparedness, watershed protection, open space preservation, and administrative expenditures related to the planning and implementation of the Measure. The specific allowable uses are outlined in the Expenditure Plan, which is part of Measure B, and which would be codified as Section 3.38.040 of the Napa County Code, if approved by the voters.

Measure B was placed on the ballot by citizen petition pursuant to the initiative process outlined in the California Elections Code. On June 16, 2026, the Board of Supervisors determined that Measure B received the required number of signatures to qualify for the ballot and directed that Measure B be placed on the ballot pursuant to their ministerial duties under Elections Code Section 9118(b) and 1405(a).

Measure B, if approved by a simple majority (50% plus one vote) of the voters voting on November 3, 2026, will result in:

- The sales tax in the cities of American Canyon, Calistoga, Napa, St. Helena, Town of Yountville and the unincorporated areas of Napa County would be increased by one-half of one percent (1/2%) for eighteen (18) years, beginning on April 1, 2027, and ending on March 31, 2045.

- The sales tax proceeds would be placed in a special fund and could be used only for wildfire preparedness, watershed protection, open space preservation, and administrative expenditures related to the planning and implementation of the Measure.

- The collected tax proceeds would be divided and distributed, 50% to Napa County and 50% to the Napa County Regional Park and Open Space District ("Park District").

- Napa County and the Park District would be required to distribute their 50% share of the tax proceeds to grantees through a competitive grant process and funding agreements. The County may issue grants only to qualifying 501c3 nonprofit organizations, with some exceptions as outlined in Measure B. The Parks District could make grants to qualifying 501c3 nonprofit corporations and public agencies as described in the Measure.

- An independent oversight committee would be created to review the receipt and expenditure of the sales tax proceeds.

- The appropriations limit for the maximum four-year period permitted by law would be increased to allow for the use of all proceeds raised by the proposed tax.

A "YES" VOTE MEANS that you want to impose a ½% sales tax, limit the use of the those proceeds to wildfire preparedness, watershed protection, open space preservation uses and administrative expenditures related to the planning and implementation of the Measure, and approve the related actions described above.

A "NO" VOTE MEANS that you do not want to impose a ½% sales tax to fund the above-described uses.